

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

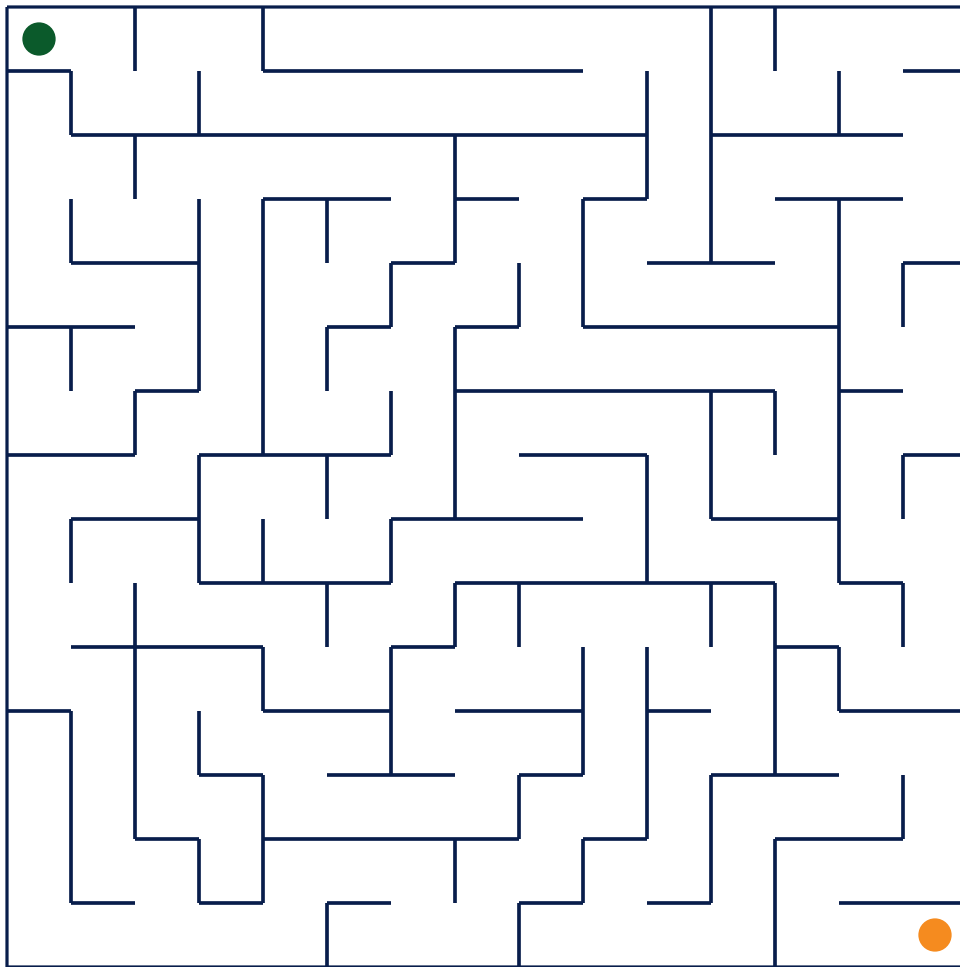
Looking for Belonging Without Knowing Where Home Is

BIG IDEA: A person can feel at home and still live apart from God. Jesus came to seek the lost and bring them home to God.

ACTIVITY 1 - FIND THE WAY HOME

Begin at FAR OFF and find the path to GOD'S HOUSEHOLD. The maze reminds us that Jesus seeks and saves the lost; we do not rescue ourselves.

START: FAR OFF



HOME: GOD'S HOUSEHOLD

MEMORY VERSE - LUKE 19:10

"For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost."

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

Luke 15 and Ephesians 2

ACTIVITY 2 - FOUR WINDOWS INTO LOSTNESS

Draw a line from each picture in Jesus' stories to what it helps us understand.

1. SHEEP

A. Valuable but out of place

2. COIN

B. Near the house but far from the father

3. YOUNGER SON

C. Wandering and helpless

4. OLDER SON

D. Chose the far country

ACTIVITY 3 - FROM FAR OFF TO FAMILY

FAR OFF

Without Christ



JESUS SEEKS

He came to save



BROUGHT NEAR

By Christ



AT HOME

God's family

THINK AND WRITE

One good place where I feel that I belong is:

That good place cannot replace God because:

Jesus seeks the lost because they are valuable, not worthless. This means:

BOTTOM LINE: Jesus came to seek the lost and bring them home to God.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

A family activity for Session 1

WORD SEARCH - WORDS THAT HELP TELL THE STORY

Find the ten words. Then circle the three words that describe what Jesus does.



FIND THESE WORDS

LOST	FOUND
JESUS	HOME
SEEK	SAVE
NEAR	FAMILY
SHEEP	COIN

JESUS SEEKS - SAVES - BRINGS NEAR

TALK ABOUT IT AT HOME

1. Why might someone be lost without feeling lost?
2. What does Luke 15 show us about the value of the lost?
3. How does Jesus bring people near to God?

THIS WEEK: Notice one place each day where you seek belonging. Thank God for good relationships, then remember that only He can be the true home of human life.

PRAY: Lord Jesus, thank You for seeking the lost. Help our family find life and belonging in You.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

A belonging audit for Session 1

CENTRAL TRUTH: Lostness is not a feeling of worthlessness. It is living apart from the God for whom human life was made, often while seeking identity and belonging elsewhere.

1 - TRACE THE MOVEMENT IN EPHESIANS 2

WITHOUT CHRIST



MADE NIGH

STRANGERS



FELLOWCITIZENS

FAR OFF



GOD'S HOUSEHOLD

2 - MY BELONGING AUDIT

When I need to know that I matter, I usually look to:

The group, achievement, image, or relationship I most fear losing is:

A good gift becomes a false home when:

Being near Christian things is not the same as belonging to Christ because:

3 - TEST THE CLAIM

A student says, "I am a good person, I attend church, and I do not feel far from God. I cannot be lost." What does Luke 15 say that is true in that statement? What does it challenge?

SEVEN-DAY CHALLENGE: Record one place each day where you seek belonging. Ask: Is this a good gift that points me toward God, or am I asking it to replace Him? Bring one honest observation next week.

If you wonder whether you belong to Christ, speak privately with a trusted leader. You do not need to pretend certainty.

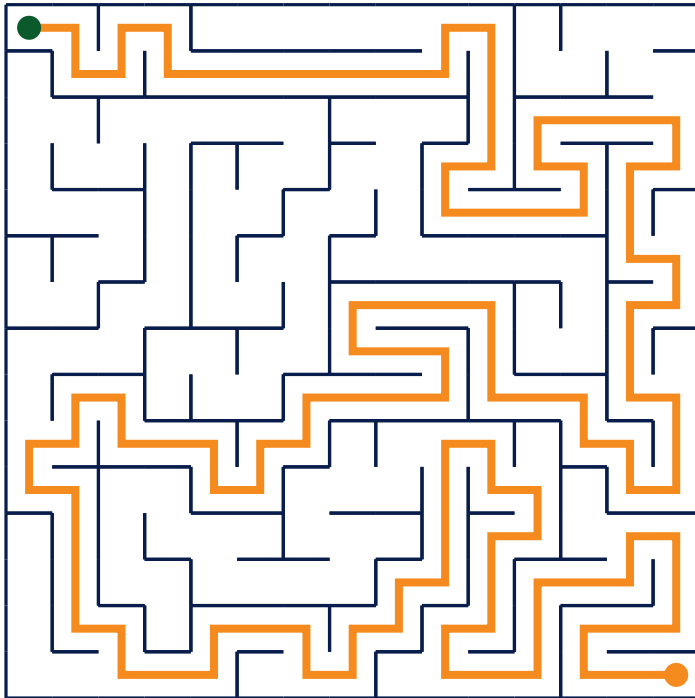
WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

Answers, family conversation, and pastoral safeguards

JUNIOR WORKSHEET ANSWERS

Activity 1 - Maze solution

START: FAR OFF



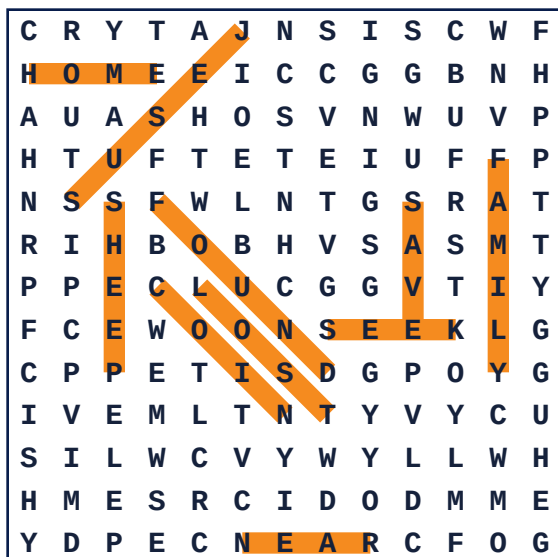
HOME: GOD'S HOUSEHOLD

Activity 2 - Four Windows

- 1-C Sheep: wandering and helpless
- 2-A Coin: valuable but out of place
- 3-D Younger son: chose the far country
- 4-B Older son: near the house but far from the father

Activity 3 movement: Far off -> Jesus seeks -> Brought near -> At home in God's household. Stress that Christ accomplishes the rescue.

TAKE-HOME WORD SEARCH ANSWERS



The ten words are LOST, FOUND, JESUS, HOME, SEEK, SAVE, NEAR, FAMILY, SHEEP, and COIN. The three action words connected to Jesus are SEEK, SAVE, and NEAR: He seeks, saves, and brings the lost near.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

Helping young people respond honestly to the Gospel

THEOLOGICAL AIM

Students should understand that lost does not mean unusually evil, worthless, or necessarily uncomfortable. Lostness concerns life apart from the God for whom humanity was made. Jesus values, seeks, saves, brings near, and gives belonging in Himself.

TEEN REFLECTION - GUIDANCE RATHER THAN A SCRIPT

The belonging audit has personal answers. Do not demand public disclosure. In the scenario, affirm that morality and church attendance may be genuine goods, but Luke 15 shows both chosen distance and religious nearness without knowing the father. Feeling near is not the same as trusting Christ.

FAMILY CONVERSATION

1. Where do people our age look for identity and belonging?
2. Which forms of belonging are good gifts?
3. How can a good gift become a replacement for God?
4. What do the sheep, coin, and two sons show differently?
5. What does Jesus do for the lost that they cannot do for themselves?

PASTORAL SAFEGUARDS

- Do not force a profession or ask students to identify publicly as saved or lost.
- Do not reassure automatically because a child prayed, was baptized, attends church, or seems sincere.
- Do not use fear, embarrassment, or puzzle completion as pressure toward a response.
- Listen carefully; return to Christ, the Gospel, present trust, and Scripture.
- Provide a private path for follow-up and involve parents appropriately.

PRIVATE INVITATION

If this lesson made you wonder whether you belong to Christ, you do not have to answer publicly or pretend certainty. Speak privately with one of us; we will listen and open the Bible with you.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

Looking for Belonging Without Knowing Where Home Is



1 FAR OFF

Without Christ. Strangers. No hope. Without God.

EPHESIANS 2:12



2 SOUGHT

Jesus came to seek and to save the lost.

LUKE 19:10



3 BROUGHT NIGH

Made nigh by the blood of Christ.

EPHESIANS 2:13



4 AT HOME

Fellowcitizens and members of God's household.

EPHESIANS 2:19

LUKE 15: FOUR WINDOWS INTO LOSTNESS



THE SHEEP

Wandering and helplessness



THE COIN

Valuable but out of place



YOUNGER SON

Chosen estrangement



OLDER SON

Near the house, far from the father

LOSTNESS DOES NOT ALWAYS LOOK LOST



NOT UNUSUALLY EVIL

Moral and kind people may still live apart from God.



NOT WORTHLESS

The lost are known, valued, and sought by Christ.



NOT UNCOMFORTABLE

Feeling at home does not prove that we are home.



NOT FAR FROM RELIGION

Nearness to Christian things is not union with Christ.

THE LOST DO NOT ALWAYS KNOW THEY ARE LOST,
BECAUSE THEY DO NOT KNOW THERE IS SOMEWHERE THEY BELONG.

"For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost." - LUKE 19:10